

CPB Initiation

Structured communication and flow ramp to safely initiate cardiopulmonary bypass



1 Closed loop communication

2 Start timer

3 Communication

- Open arterial clamp
- Flow less than 500 mL/min

4 Communication

- Open venous clamp slowly
- Observe reservoir volume ↑ increasing (draining patient)

5 Increase flow / RPMs + increase venous drainage

See Flow Ramp — Worked Example

6 Confirm

- e2.4 cl
- Good drainage
- Zero CVP
- No ejection
- Good line pressure
- Colour difference in lines

7 Communication

“Going on bypass”



“Arterial on”

“Venous open”

FLOW RAMP — WORKED EXAMPLE

Flow	Venous open	CVP	Arterial waveform	Line pressure
1/4	25%	8		80
1/2	50%	6		110
3/4	75%	4		150
Full	100%	0		180
Flat line = zero ejections				

FULL-FLOW CONFIRMATION

- ☐ e2.4 cl
- ☐ Good drainage
- ☐ Zero CVP
- ☐ No ejections
- ☐ Good line pressure
- ☐ Colour difference in lines

⚠ WARNING

These must be confirmed before communications

“Full flow”